

new Guest account. Once this has been added, dragging down the notification shade shows the user icon and tapping on that allows you to switch between the accounts. On OnePlus, tapping on the icon from the start allows you to Add Guest. Xiaomi phones handle this via Second Space. Just in case your phone does not support this feature, you can still rely on Private Mode, another standard feature from Android which does the same thing, but does so by locking your private apps or files, which you need to manually specify.

11 Make fingerprint scanner work faster

This is not as much of a hack as it is advice. Fingerprint scanners are pretty nifty these days and quite often we do not even notice that there's any scanning going on, until it fails. However, to give it a slight edge and to give yourself a little more flexibility to unlock your phone even when your finger is not so ideally placed on the sensor, you need to do something pretty simple – register multiple fingerprints of the same finger. Ideally, in each of these cases, register one particular edge of your finger in a way that Android still accepts it as a print. However, some manufacturers do configure this feature to reject multiple fingerprints of the same finger, so you might need to try a few times before you can register the whole thing. You can add up to five fingerprints this way on most phones and get your phone to unlock regardless of how you place your finger on the sensor. Keep in mind that this also means your phone will be prone to false positives.

12 Encrypt your phone's data

Keeping people around you from accessing your phone physically might be a straightforward task. However, to keep it safe from hackers lurking in the nearby networks might not be so easy. There's a number of attacks, like the Man In the Middle attack, that take advantage of lapses in network security and spy on user data that is openly available on shared networks. First of all, using public networks is inviting trouble. However, you do not always have good cellular connectivity and public networks are the

only option. In such cases, Android provides encryption on all devices to keep your data safe. While different device manufacturers might implement it differently, it is usually under the Privacy or Security sub-menus. Some phones allow you to encrypt data on a per-app basis, however, the Android



standard is to encrypt all data on the phone. Note that this requires you to enter the lock screen password every time you reboot, which will also take longer than usual. A number of features like bluetooth devices will be disabled when encryption is enabled.

13 Translate what you type

If you're on Android, chances are you're using Gboard – the Google Keyboard. While there are a number of things you can pull off with this one (like searching, duh), perhaps none of those things is more useful than the Google Translate feature that is baked into the keyboard. That's right, Gboard has a baked in live translation feature. Just tap the Google logo on the left on the top bar of the keyboard and hit the Google Translate logo on the bar beside it. The keyboard goes into translate mode where an additional module over the keyboard lets you pick a source language and a destination language (with a strangely redundant Detect language feature on the source side) and then you can type away in your language only to see it translated into the language of your choice. The only drawback with this is that you have to do it each time you intend to send a message, instead of being able to lock it in place for a particular conversation or time.



14 Stay in control of your device in case of loss or theft

You can protect your phone from loss or theft through a few simple steps. The first step is to make sure that you use either a pattern, fingerprint or PIN code to lock your phone. In Settings, navigate to Security & Location, and check the status of Find My Device. If you have signed in to a Google account, this setting should be turned on by default. If you do not see a blue check mark next to the setting, tap on it and toggle it to turn it on. In order to locate the device, it must be turned on, logged in to your Google account, connected to a mobile or WiFi network, and have its location turned on. The location setting is available in the Privacy subsection of the Security & Location menu. There are three location options available, High accuracy, Battery saving and Device only. It is best to use the High accuracy location setting, which combines network information, along with the GPS signals. In case of loss or theft, just go to android.com/find. You have to login with the main profile of the device. Bear in mind that the device will immediately get an alert. You can now remotely wipe the data, lock the phone if you have not protected it with a pattern or PIN

code, and type in a display message to show on the screen. If you have just lost the phone, then you can remotely play a sound at full volume to help you locate it, even if the device has been set on silent. You can also use another Android device to find your phone, by installing the

Google Find My Device app, developed by Google LLC. Some manufacturers, including Samsung and Xiaomi have their own applications to help you locate a lost or stolen device.

15 Record your screen

One of the best applications to use for recording your screen is AZ Screen Recorder. Once you install the app, you have to give it the requisite permissions. It might be necessary to restart the device after the permissions are granted, for the app to work as